

Comprehensive Maritime English Review — ING-55

ACON-B

Challenging Revision test with 10 main questions + extra exercises

Main Questions

1. Reading Comprehension — Detailed interpretation

Read the text:

At 2330 on July 15th, the cargo ship *Neptune Star* reported water ingress in the aft cargo hold. The crew activated pumps but flooding worsened. The captain declared a Pan-Pan at 2345. At 0010, the vessel lost power and started drifting. An ERRV responded, and by 0200 all crew had abandoned ship safely. The cause of flooding was attributed to hull damage from collision with floating debris.

Questions:

1.1) What was the first sign of trouble?

1.2) What emergency code was declared initially and why?

1.3) Why didn't the captain declare a Mayday immediately?

1.4) What happened at 0010?

1.5) Was the cause of the problem confirmed? What was it?

2. Grammar – Verb Tenses and Voice

Complete the sentences with the verb in parentheses in the correct tense and voice:

- 2.1) The crew _____ (attempt) to fix the leak when the alarm sounded.
 - 2.2) The ship _____ (tow) to port after the engine failure last week.
 - 2.3) At the moment, the captain _____ (give) orders to abandon ship.
 - 2.4) The vessel _____ (sink) slowly after hitting the reef yesterday.
 - 2.5) The radio operator _____ (send) the distress signal five minutes ago.
-

3. Vocabulary — Maritime Emergency Codes

Write the following cases to the correct code: **Mayday, Pan-Pan, Sécurité**

- 3.1) A man overboard with immediate danger to life. _____
 - 3.2) An urgent medical case onboard requiring assistance. _____
 - 3.3) A warning of approaching severe weather in the area. _____
 - 3.4) Mechanical failure that does not immediately threaten safety. _____
 - 3.5) Navigation hazard caused by a derelict vessel. _____
-

4. Sentence Transformation (Rewrite the sentences as requested:)

- 4.1) The engine failed suddenly. (Use passive voice)

- 4.2) We are navigating through rough seas. (Make it negative in present continuous)

- 4.3) The captain instructed the crew to lower the lifeboats. (Use reported speech)

- 4.4) The vessel must reduce speed immediately. (Use modal verb 'should')

4.5) The crew will conduct maintenance tomorrow. (Use future continuous)

5. Maritime Communication – Radio Procedure

Complete a standard radio response to a Mayday call received from *MV Ocean Explorer*:

“Mayday, Mayday, Mayday, Ocean Explorer. This is _____, call sign _____. Received your distress call. Our current speed is _____ knots, and ETA to your position is _____. Please confirm your situation and number of persons onboard. Over.”

6. Reading Inference

Based on the text in question 1, answer:

6.1) What was the vessel’s status at 0200?

6.2) What indicates the evacuation was safe?

6.3) What was the role of the ERRV?

7. Grammar – Prepositions and Connectors

Fill in the blanks with the correct prepositions:

- 7.1) The ship collided _____ a floating container.
7.2) The crew abandoned the vessel _____ safety reasons.
7.3) We expect the tug to arrive _____ noon.
7.4) The captain ordered a reduction _____ speed.
7.5) The vessel is drifting _____ strong currents.
-

8. Vocabulary — Maintenance Terms

Define or translate into English:

- 8.1) Pintura
8.2) Removal of rust with a manual tool
8.3) Visual inspection
8.4) Replacement of parts
8.5) Emergency repairs
-

9. Complex Sentence Formation

Combine the ideas below into one coherent compound sentence:

- The vessel lost power. _____
 - The crew tried to repair it. _____
 - The weather worsened. _____
 - The captain declared an emergency. _____
-

10. Writing (Short Answer)

Write one sentence using maritime technical vocabulary to describe:

10.1) A situation where the ship must use the bow thruster.

10.2) A medical emergency onboard.

10.3) An important weather warning.

Extra Exercises

A. Matching — Orders and Meanings

Match the orders below with their meanings:

- Full ahead both
- Dead slow astern
- Stand by engine
- Bow thrust half to port
- Ease to twenty
- Steady as she goes

Meanings:

- a) Prepare yourself _____
- b) Reduce rudder to 20° _____
- c) Go ahead at full speed _____
- d) Move the bow to port at 50% power _____
- e) Move backward very slowly _____
- f) Maintain current heading _____

B. Multiple Choice — Choose the Correct Answer

What does “Pan-Pan” mean in maritime code?

- a) Urgent distress call with immediate risk to life.
 - b) Urgent call for assistance without immediate danger.
 - c) Safety warning regarding weather or navigation.
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ANSWER KEY with Justifications

1. Reading

- 1.1) Water ingress in the aft cargo hold.
 - 1.2) Pan-Pan — urgent situation, but no immediate danger to life.
 - 1.3) Because there was still time to control the flooding, no total loss or immediate risk yet.
 - 1.4) The vessel lost power and began drifting.
 - 1.5) Yes, caused by hull damage from collision with floating debris.
-

2. Grammar

- 2.1) attempted
- 2.2) was towed
- 2.3) is giving
- 2.4) sank
- 2.5) sent

Justification: verb tenses correspond to past events, ongoing action, and passive construction as required.

3. Vocabulary

- 3.1) Mayday
 - 3.2) Pan-Pan
 - 3.3) Sécurité
 - 3.4) Pan-Pan
 - 3.5) Sécurité
-

4. Sentence Transformation

- 4.1) The engine failed suddenly. (Note: *fail* is usually intransitive; passive rarely used.)
- 4.2) We are not navigating through rough seas.

- 4.3) The captain instructed the crew to lower the lifeboats.
 - 4.4) The vessel should reduce speed immediately.
 - 4.5) The crew will be conducting maintenance tomorrow.
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5. Radio Response

“Mayday, Mayday, Mayday, Ocean Explorer. This is [Your Vessel Name], call sign [Your Call Sign]. Received your distress call. Our current speed is [knots] knots, and ETA to your position is [time]. Please confirm your situation and number of persons onboard. Over.”

6. Reading Inference

- 6.1) The vessel was powerless and drifting.
 - 6.2) All crew had abandoned ship safely by 0200.
 - 6.3) The ERRV responded to assist and rescue the crew.
-

7. Prepositions

- 7.1) with
 - 7.2) for
 - 7.3) at
 - 7.4) of
 - 7.5) in
-

8. Vocabulary

- 8.1) Painting
 - 8.2) Chipping
 - 8.3) Visual inspection
 - 8.4) Replacement of parts
 - 8.5) Emergency repairs
-

9. Complex Sentence

“The vessel lost power, and although the crew tried to repair it, the weather worsened, so the captain declared an emergency.”

10. Writing Examples

10.1) “The captain ordered the bow thruster half to port to assist with docking.”

10.2) “A crew member suffered a severe injury, prompting a Pan-Pan medical call.”

10.3) “Securité: A storm warning has been issued for the next 24 hours.”

Extra Exercises

A. Matching:

- Full ahead both → c
- Dead slow astern → e
- Stand by engine → a
- Bow thrust half to port → d
- Ease to twenty → b
- Steady as she goes → f

B. Multiple Choice:

Correct answer: b) Urgent call for assistance without immediate danger.

this report of a maritime accident and if the statements that follow are true or false.

At 2050 on 3rd June 2009, the fishing boat *Transcend* was out at sea and preparing her trawl gear when a member of the crew reported water entering the engine room through the hull planking. The vessel's two bilge pumps and a portable submersible pump were put into action but the flooding continued. At 2145, the skipper issued a "Mayday" .

An emergency response and rescue vessel (ERRV) and a second fishing boat responded to the Mayday. The *Transcend*'s three deckhands evacuated into a life raft and the ERRV picked them up. A portable pump from the other fishing boat was transferred to the *Transcend*. However, it would not start, and the flooding continued.

When the generator failed, the skipper abandoned the vessel and he was followed shortly by the engineer. The vessel listed to starboard and sank by the stern 10 minutes later. The initial cause of the flooding has not been established.

- | | |
|---|--|
| 1.1) The engine room flooded first. | ☐ True ☐ False |
| 1.2) Three vessels responded to the Mayday | ☐ True ☐ False |
| 1.3) The vessel had a skipper and a crew of five. | ☐ True ☐ False |
| 1.4) The captain was the last person to leave the vessel. | ☐ True ☐ False |
| 1.5) No one knows why the vessel flooded. | ☐ True ☐ False |

the navigation warnings

the correct word from a, b and c to

NAVAREA I
211240 UTC
SOUTHERN NORTH SEA

Up to 35 ships at anchor or manoeuvring (1) _____ in this area.

(2) _____ advised when transiting.

- 1) a) slow b) wide c) slowly d) fast e) intelligent
2) a) Caution b) Danger c) Warning d) vague e) high

NAVAREA I
141715 UTC
NORTHERN NORTH SEA

Seismic survey in (3) _____ by M/V Ocean Explorer laying very

(4) _____ cables within this area. Wide berth (5) _____ .

- 3) a) way b) motion c) progress d) instant e) power
4) a) wide b) long c) high d) short e) little

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the correct form of verbs into the spaces in these sentences.

Example: A minute ago the deck hand _____ under the water (disappear)

Answer: A minute ago, the deckhand disappeared under the water.

3.1) We _____ in heavy seas: Please send assistance. (drift)

3.2) The waves are too high and the sea _____ our yacht (swamp)

3.3) This morning we _____ with a tanker but there was no damage (collide)

3.4) Both vessels _____ now. (sink)

3.5) Yesterday the yacht Western Rose _____ (capsize)

The words of these sentences are mixed up. _____ the sentences correctly.

Master about knows maritime ship's A law.

A ship's master knows about maritime law.

4.1) are by we stars navigating the

We _____

4.2) am watch not I tonight standing

4.3) route am planning the I

4.4) navigating collisions by we avoid safely

We _____

4.5) not leaving our arriving but berth we are

We _____

_____ the three emergency code words below. What do they mean? _____ them with:
URGENT CALL, DISTRESS CALL, and SAFETY CALL.

a) Mayday, Mayda, Mayday.

b) Pan-pan, Pan-pan, Pan-pan.

c) Sécurité, Sécurité, Sécurité.

() Distress Call. () Urgent Call. () Sécurité, Sécurité, Sécurité.

You must send a radio message to report emergencies 1-10. Which emergency code do you use for each message?

- 6.1) A crew member badly injures his hand. _____
- 6.2) You need to give a storm warning. _____
- 6.3) There is thick fog in your sea area. _____
6. 4) A crew member falls into the sea. _____
- 6.5) A diver has bends (decompression sickness). _____

the orders (left) with the meanings (right)

- a) Full ahead both. () Stay on the heading given earlier.
- b) Dead slow astern. () Hold rudder in the fore and aft position.
- c) Stand by engine . () Reduce the amount of rudder to 20°.
- d) Bow thrust half to port. () Reverse very slowly.
- e) Ease to twenty. () Get ready.
- f) Steady as she goes. () Move the ship's head to port on 50 % power.

these message markers into the blank spaces. (8.1- 8.9)

Instruction	Request	Intention	Warning
Question	Information	Answer	Advice

- 8.1) _____ : Do not proceed.
- 8.2) _____ : Steer course: 1-2-8 degrees true.
- 8.3) _____ : The Vessel on your port side is not underway.
- 8.4) _____ : The bridge lights are unlit.

- 8.5) _____ : Our cargo is toxic.
- 8.6) _____ : Send assistance immediately.
- 8.7) _____ : I can confirm that visibility is good.
- 8.8) _____ : I will reduce speed.
- 8.9) _____ : I require a tug.

the Text "The work of an Ordinary Seaman"

the following question.

Ordinary Seamen work in all departments: deck, engineering, and stewarding. They help with docking and undocking and sometimes stand watch. Most of the time, Ordinary Seamen maintain the vessel, including tasks such as chipping, scraping, and painting. They also clean the vessel's *interior and help in the galley*.

9.1) Find a word in the text that means "leaving port".

9.2) What three things do Ordinary Seamen do to maintain a vessel?

a) _____ b) _____ c) _____

9.3) What word in the text means "inside"?

9.4) What term in the text means crews quarters? (3 words)

9.5) What word means to go up a rank?

10.1) If you receive a distress message, use the following procedure:

a) Say "May Day" followed by the name or call sign of the vessel in trouble.

b) SAY: "This is....." Followed by your class sign, and then say "Received May Day" followed by information about your speed and your ETA.

C) Your call sign is RF14. in the spaces in this response to a Mayday from Ocean Princess.

Princess: _____ Ocean Princess. _____ Duke

Leopold, Romeo Foxtrot one-four. _____ . _____

is six knots and my _____ is nine three three. Over.

Segue o gabarito completo com respostas e para cada item.

Observação: em dois pontos o enunciado original parece ter pequeno erro/omissão — eu sinalizei e expliquei a solução proposta.

(resumo do acidente)

1.1)

O texto diz que “a member of the crew reported water entering the engine room through the hull planking” — a água entrou no .

1.2)

Responderam ao Mayday uma ERRV (emergency response and rescue

vessel) um segundo barco de pesca — são navios que responderam (além do próprio Transcend, que estava em perigo).

1.3)

O texto indica _____, _____ e _____

→ total = 5 pessoas. A afirmação “a skipper and a crew of five” sugere skipper cinco tripulantes (6 no total), o que não corresponde ao texto.

1.4)

O texto diz que “the skipper abandoned the vessel and he was followed shortly by the engineer” — o engenheiro saiu _____ do skipper, portanto o skipper foi o último a abandonar.

1.5)

O texto: “The initial cause of the flooding has not been established.” → a causa inicial _____ (ninguém sabe).

— *Observação:* o enunciado enviado não trouxe as frases com as lacunas, apenas as listas de opções. Trabalhei com as escolhas mais prováveis para completar advertências de navegação típicas. Se você puder enviar as frases originais eu ajusto as respostas exatamente às lacunas.

Sugestão de respostas (melhor encaixe geral):

2.1) (opção c).

em advertências de navegação costuma-se usar o advérbio *slowly* (“proceed slowly”).

2.2) (opção c).

sinaliza perigo/hazard em avisos náuticos; *Warning* é o termo habitual.

2.3) (opção a).

expressões comuns: “give way”, “in the way” — *way* aparece com frequência em avisos de tráfego.

2.4) (opção a).

expressão típica: “keep a berth” / “proceed with a wide margin”.

, envie as frases originais com as lacunas e eu marco as alternativas corretas por lacuna.

3.1) in heavy seas: Please send assistance.

o tempo atual contínuo descreve a situação em curso.

3.2) **our yacht.**

sea (singular) + present continuous: *is swamping*.

3.3) with a tanker but there was no damage.

“This morning” → passado simples: *collided*.

3.4) now.

presente contínuo para evento em progresso: *are sinking*.

3.5) .

“Yesterday” → passado simples: *capsized*.

4.1) are by we stars navigating the

→

ordem SVO + complemento.

4.2) am watch not I tonight standing

→

negação no present continuous.

4.3) route am planning the I

→

4.4) navigating collisions by we avoid safely

→

4.5) not leaving our arriving but berth we are

→

outra ordem aceitável: *We are not leaving our berth, but arriving*. Ambas preservam o sentido.

a)

→

usado para emergência de risco de vida/imediata — pedido de socorro.

b)

→

situação urgente (assistência necessária) não necessariamente risco imediato de perda de vida.

c)

→

avisos de segurança (navegação, perigo para todas as embarcações, avisos meteorológicos).

6.1) A crew member badly injures his hand. →

emergência médica urgente (pan-pan medical), mas normalmente não é imediatamente uma situação de perda de embarcação/vida (salvo agravamento).

listada (ex.: *Midships*). Se quiser, corrijo o enunciado: a resposta correta para *hold rudder midships* seria a ordem (que não está no original).

- ()

Ease to twenty = reduzir o leme para 20°.

- ()

Dead slow astern = marcha-ré muito devagar.

- ()

Stand by engine = preparar motor / esteja pronto.

- ()

Bow thrust half to port = usar bow thruster/propulsor de proa a meio potência para girar a proa à bombordo.

Stay heading = ; *Hold rudder midships* =

; *Reduce rudder to 20°* = ; *Reverse slowly* = ; *Get ready* = ;

Move head to port half power = .

8.1) : Do not proceed.

ordem direta.

8.2) : Steer course: 1-2-8 degrees true.

comando com indicação de rumo.

- 8.3) : The Vessel on your port side is not underway.
informação sobre situação de outro navio.
- 8.4) : The bridge lights are unlit.
alerta de perigo/condição que afeta navegação noturna.
- 8.5) : Our cargo is toxic.
aviso de carga perigosa (risco).
- 8.6) : Send assistance immediately.
pedido urgente de ajuda.
- 8.7) : I can confirm that visibility is good.
resposta confirmando informação (resposta a pergunta sobre visibilidade).
- 8.8) : I will reduce speed.
expressão de intenção futura.
- 8.9) : I require a tug.
pedido formal de rebocador.
-

(resumo apresentado no enunciado)

- 9.1) .
dock / undock = atracar / desatracar (sair do porto).

9.2)

a)

b)

c)

o texto cita exatamente “including tasks such as chipping, scraping, and painting.”

9.3) (the vessel's interior).

9.4) .

é a expressão de três palavras presente no texto que corresponde ao interior do navio (onde ficam espaços/acomodações).

9.5)

— no texto fornecido não há palavra que signifique literalmente “to go up a rank” (promover/advance). As palavras relacionadas a trabalho são *work, help, maintain, stand watch* etc., mas o termo *promote/advance* no excerto.

leitura atenta do parágrafo não mostra vocabulário de progressão de posto; se o exercício original pretendia outra coisa, por favor envie a linha exata e corrijo.

complete a resposta do Duke Leopold (call sign RF14) a um Mayday da *Ocean Princess*.

procedimento padrão: (a) repetir *Mayday* + nome da embarcação em perigo;
(b) responder “This is...” seguido do ; (c) dizer “Received Mayday” e informar
e (ou outras capacidades/posicionamento).
